

Esteban Vizcarrondo

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EDUCATION

Ph.D., Agricultural and Applied Economics University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign <i>Dissertation:</i> “Three Essays on Commodity Market Price Analysis” <i>Advisor:</i> Teresa Serra, Ph.D.	2021–2027 (<i>expected</i>)
M.Sc., Mathematical Statistics University of Puerto Rico–Mayagüez <i>Thesis:</i> “Association Between Chemical Manufacturing Sector and Cancer Incidence in Puerto Rico Using Spatial Regression Analysis” <i>Advisor:</i> Julio C. Hernández, Ph.D.	2019–2021
B.A.S., Agricultural Economics, <i>Magna Cum Laude</i> University of Puerto Rico–Mayagüez Minor: Practical and Professional Ethics	2013–2018
AEA Summer Program Michigan State University	2017, 2018

FIELDS OF INTEREST

Agricultural economics, commodity futures and options markets; price analysis; applied time series econometrics.

JOB MARKET PAPER

“How Much Is the Smirk Worth? Downside Risk Pricing in Cattle Options” (*with Teresa Serra and Andrew McKenzie*)

We test whether cattle option markets reprice downside risk after catastrophic disruptions, using the August 9, 2019 Tyson Holcomb fire as a major shock to U.S. beef processing capacity. Within a filtered-historical-simulation framework, we decompose the variance risk premium into a base component and a leverage component that isolates option-implied downside asymmetry from historical (futures-only) asymmetry. Using difference-in-differences with corn as the control, we find the leverage premium for live cattle increases by roughly 14–29% after the fire and attenuates toward zero as processing capacity is restored, while feeder cattle—further upstream from the processing bottleneck—show no comparable response. The repricing implies about \$1.60–1.90 per head in additional cost for a representative short-dated, out-of-the-money live cattle put.

WORKING PAPERS

“How HFT Speed Disruptions Affect Market Quality in Energy ETF Markets” (*with Teresa Serra*)

Identifies high frequency traders (HFT) speed effects in energy ETFs using weather-induced microwave disruptions along the Chicago–New York corridor.

“Export Basis Shocks in Major Soybean Markets” (*with Teresa Serra, Taejun Mo, William Ridley, and Todd Hubbs*)

Shifting-Mean Global VAR model of soybean basis transmission across the U.S., Brazil, Argentina, and China.

EXTENSION PUBLICATIONS

Vizcarrondo, E. and J. Janzen (2023). “[The Weather Risk Premium in Coffee Futures Prices.](#)” *farmdoc daily* (13):237, Department of Agricultural and Consumer Economics, University of Illinois at Urbana–Champaign.

PRESENTATIONS

NCCC-134 Applied Commodity Price Analysis, Forecasting, and Market Risk Management	2024, 2026
Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting	2018, 2019
Puerto Rican Society of Agricultural Sciences Annual Assembly	2018

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant Office for Futures and Options Research, University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign	2023–Present
Graduate Research Assistant Department of Agricultural Economics and Rural Sociology University of Puerto Rico–Mayagüez	2020–2021

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant , Environmental Economics Department of Agricultural and Consumer Economics, UIUC	2022–2023, 2024–2025
Teaching Assistant , Pre-Calculus Department of Mathematical Sciences, UPRM	2019–2021

SERVICE

Journal Referee , <i>Journal of Commodity Markets</i>	
Treasurer , Graduate Student Organization (GSO)	2023–2025
Member , Grievance Committee	2023–2025
Member , Course and Curricula Committee (<i>appointed</i>) Department of Agricultural and Consumer Economics, UIUC	2025–2026
Student Senator , College of Agricultural Sciences University of Puerto Rico–Mayagüez	2017-2018

SKILLS

Software: R, Python, STATA, L^AT_EX
Languages: Spanish (native), English (fluent), French (basic), Arabic (basic).

REFERENCES

Teresa Serra, Ph.D. Department of Agricultural and Consumer Economics University of Illinois Urbana– Champaign	Scott Irwin, Ph.D. Department of Agricultural and Consumer Economics University of Illinois Urbana– Champaign	Andrew McKenzie, Ph.D. Department of Agricultural Eco- nomics and Agribusiness University of Arkansas
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